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A COSTLY AFFAIR Passengers are already paying a fortune for air travel on sectors where Go First had flights

question mark on the country's ambitions of making GIFT City near Ahmedabad a global aircraft leasing and financing hub.

On May 12, the not-for-profit Bermuda-based Aviation Working Group (AWG) comprising global aviation equipment manufacturers, leasing firms and financial institutions, issued a watch list notice on Go First.

TICKET TRAJECTORY

Prior to Go First filing for voluntary insolvency, Jet Airways had gone belly up in 2019. At that time, the full-service carrier used to operate a fleet of 123

aircraft, and enjoyed coveted slots both at domestic and international airports. "Two airlines going belly up in such quick succession indicates that all is not well with India's aviation sector, despite a robust recovery post the Covid-19 pandemic," says KLA's Kumar.

Last year, there was tremendous expectation of Jet Airways reviving under a new management. But, following the exit of its CEO and other core team members, the plan is in limbo again. "We are all aware of the massive orders being placed by Air India as well as IndiGo. This is in stark contrast with the Jet

and Go First situation," he adds.

Meanwhile, passengers are already having to cough up a fortune for air travel on sectors where Go First had flights. Unless the void created by the airline's near demise is bridged quickly, ticket prices will continue to soar due to a virtual duopoly enjoyed by market leaders IndiGo and Air India. "Airlines have gone up two to three times, with the result that people have been cancelling bookings since they are unable to rebook at the prices that Go First was offering," says Jyoti Mayal, President of Travel Agents Association of India (TAAI). "Beyond that,